

dorm dao



Oregon

Presented by: Xander Millard & Jeremy Mitaux



SOLANA

Solana, \$SOL

Executive Summary

Pitch Summary

Rating	Fairly Valued
Current Price	136.38
Price Target	\$300.00
Action Recommended	Buy
Recommended Size	3 ETH
Native Staking	Yes

Key Statistics

Network	Solana
Token Standard	SPL
Category	Smart Contracts
SubCategory	PoH/PoS
Circulating Market Cap (\$B)	\$71.89
Fully Diluted Market Cap (\$B)	\$81.69
52 Week Price Range	\$96.59 - \$294.33
24-Hour Trading Volume	\$4,740,431,455
TVL	\$7,257,347,579
Last Week Protocol Fees	5000 lamports

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Category Overview & Thesis

Layer 1 blockchains form the foundational infrastructure of Web3. They support smart contracts, dApps, on-chain economies, and use cases still unforeseen. As global demand for scalable, decentralized computing grows - as seen in finance, gaming, and RWA - the Layer 1 category is undergoing a pivotal transition. The next generation of L1s must balance the blockchain trilemma - security, scalability, and decentralization - while also appealing to developers and institutions.

Project Overview

Solana is a high-throughput Layer 1 blockchain launched in 2020. Leveraging the novel Proof of History mechanism combined with Proof of State, Solana is able to deliver sub-second finality and low transaction costs. Its single shard parallel execution architecture enables the chain to scale for thousands of transactions per second. This makes it an ideal platform for DeFi, gaming, emergin DePIN networks, and real world assets. With over 1500 validators, a rapidly growing developer community, and adoption from institutional giants like Visa, Shopify, and soon to be US traded ETFs, Solana has proven capable of being THE layer 1.

Project Thesis

Solana is one of the most capable general-purpose blockchain for global consumer-scale usage today. Its performance on a monolithic chain removes complexity and latency, allowing dApps to scale without compromising UX. Solana is no longer just a faster Ethereum alternative—it's a self-sustaining ecosystem. As Layer 1s become commoditized, Solana stands out as the chain best positioned to meet both Web2 performance expectations and Web3 values—making it a strategic long-term hold.



General Background on Protocol

Solana is a layer-1 blockchain platform designed to solve the scalability issues negatively affecting many other blockchains, like Ethereum. It uses an innovative Proof of History (PoH) consensus mechanism and Proof of Stake (PoS) to achieve high throughput and low latency. It's a High-performance blockchain architecture that can handle up to 710,000 transactions per second. Different from most platforms, Solana uses Proof of History (PoH) which ensures event order and time without having to trust one person or entity to verify time. It also uses Proof of Stake (PoS) to validate blocks, and manage leader elections. Another cool part of solana is that it uses what is called Streaming Proof of Replication, which proves storage of data quickly. It also has System Roles, for example Leaders, Verifiers, Validators, and Replicators. Overall Solana seems suitable so far to solve the problem of scalability in the blockchain realm.

Macro Factors Impacting Protocol

In many ways the macro climate of the blockchain industry seems to reflect the calm before the storm. Solana made a surge in late 2024 early 2025 highlighted by the launch of Official Trump. The frenzie around such a project gave the layer-1 extensive media coverage. For many this was a repeated story. Large numbers of people see Solana purely as a cheaper alternative to Ethereum, where developers can easily launch tokens with doubtful utility in the hopes of running a quick profit. To this I say yes. In the five years that Solana has been operating, much of the activity on chain has been used to handle the transfer of questionable digital assets. However the world is changing quickly, people are learning of the benefits of blockchain, and Solana is positioned extremely well as a proven layer-1 to capitalize on the ensuing wave of demand for block space.



The current US administration is heralded as the “first crypto friendly administration.” President Trump clearly has interacted with Solana with his crypto project, and the project has been mentioned on the list for the possible Federal Crypto Reserve. To many investors, Solana now seems a core strategic asset alongside Bitcoin and Ethereum - in the case of mainstream adoption, this is where you want to be.

In parallel the regulatory environment around crypto has become more favorable. Canadian asset managers rolled out Solana exchange traded funds on April 16, and recently the SEC acknowledged filings for Solana based ETFs. These could possibly be available by the end of 2025. Bitcoin Spot ETFs allowed for billions in inflows and multiple all time highs. In just one year, products like BlackRock’s iShares Bitcoin Trust (IBIT) accumulated over \$52 billion in assets. Solana ETFs can likewise serve as a catalyst for growth.

The Team

- Founder and CEO: Anatoly Yakovenko

Yakovenko spent nearly 12 years at Qualcomm, leading teams on operating systems and working on technologies like virtual reality and 3D cameras. He also held engineering roles at Mesosphere and Dropbox. In 2017, he authored Solana's whitepaper, introducing the Proof of History (PoH) consensus mechanism to enhance blockchain scalability.

- Co-Founder: Raj Gokal

Before Solana, Gokal was a venture investor at General Catalyst and co-founded Sano, a consumer medical device company. As COO of Solana Labs, he manages daily operations and business strategy, playing a pivotal role in the ecosystem's growth.

- Co-Founder: Greg Fitzgerald

A seasoned systems engineer with a focus on programming languages, particularly Rust. Worked at Qualcomm, where he collaborated with Yakovenko. Co-founded Solana, contributing significantly to its technical architecture and development.

- Co-Founder: Eric Williams



Holds a Ph.D. in particle physics. Focuses on data science and token economics. As Chief Scientist, he leads research efforts, particularly in the areas of data analysis and economic modeling for the network.

- Co-Founder: Stephen Akridge

Experienced engineer specializing in GPU optimization. Worked at Qualcomm and Intel, focusing on component design and engineering. Played a crucial role in enhancing Solana's throughput by offloading signature verification to GPUs

- Advisor: Nikita Bier

Entrepreneur known for creating social apps like TBH (acquired by Facebook) and Gas (acquired by Discord). Joined as an advisor to assist in expanding Solana's mobile application ecosystem, leveraging his expertise in viral growth and product design.

- Solana Foundation (Non-profit)
- Solana labs

General Auditing Background for Protocol

The Solana Foundation has a long history working with auditing firms to ensure network security. Both the Solana Foundation and the broader Solana ecosystem have undergone extensive security audits at multiple levels. These include the layer 1 protocol, validator code, runtime environment, and key programs like the Solana Program Library (SPL).

Halborn, a leading blockchain auditing firm, is one such partner. They've built a close relationship with the Solana Foundation focusing on the ecosystem, Solana Labs, and Anza. In particular Halborn has conducted thorough security assessments of the Solana Layer 1 blockchain and SPL programs. Furthermore Halborn has reviewed Solana's Sealevel Runtime since v1.9, released early 2022. The assessments have continually checked iterative new revisions of Solana code ahead of mainnet releases to ensure security and reliability. Beyond Halbrn, Solana has worked with firms such as Ottersec, Zellic, NCC Group, Kudelski, and Neodyme.

In addition to the core protocol, there is great support for the auditing of the many DeFi, DePIN, and gaming projects on the Solana ecosystem. GitHub



features an extensive repository of resources for developers to learn about Solana smart contract security, auditing, and exploits.

Specifics on What Protocol Does

First the user sends a transaction (sending token, creating an NFT, executing a smart contract). The Transaction includes the Sender/Receiver, instructions (how much is being traded), and Signatures. Then (PoH) First Time Stamps the order of transactions and when they were received. (PoS) Follows and Then a Leader Batches the transactions, The Leader (puts all the information into a new block). Validators make sure the leader did the packing correctly. Once $\frac{2}{3}$ of the total stake confirms the block it is considered finalized. Then the block stores the ledger. Lastly this enables the use of smart contracts. Who really uses solana

Why the Protocol Offering Matters to Consumers

Solana from the start has placed an emphasis on accessibility. The foundation believes that a technology that isn't accessible isn't revolutionary. To achieve this goal, the blockchain aims to provide low cost fees that can perform thousands of transactions per second. Through this Solana provides a unified ecosystem that doesn't require the need for layer 2 solutions, which add additional steps of roll ups and bridging. The complexity of such an ecosystem worsens the user experience on chain.

Today Solana is already being used by thousands of communities which rely on the daily functioning of Solana. It is a diverse and growing space with a multitude of DeFi applications and markets. DePIN services such as Helium bring 5G networks on chain. Research done by Messari highlights the explosive adoption of Solana where TVL grew from around \$0.4B in Q3 2013 to \$5.6B in Q3 2024. This growth has only continued when in early 2025 TVL reached over 11 billion USD. In comparison Ethereum has yet to reclaim the all time high



reached in 2021. This shift indicates the tide of the market, where developers



Another key indicator for the health of the Solana ecosystem is the growth of the network's stablecoin supply. These digital assets, which serve as the backbone of on-chain liquidity and user activity, have shown remarkable resilience and expansion.

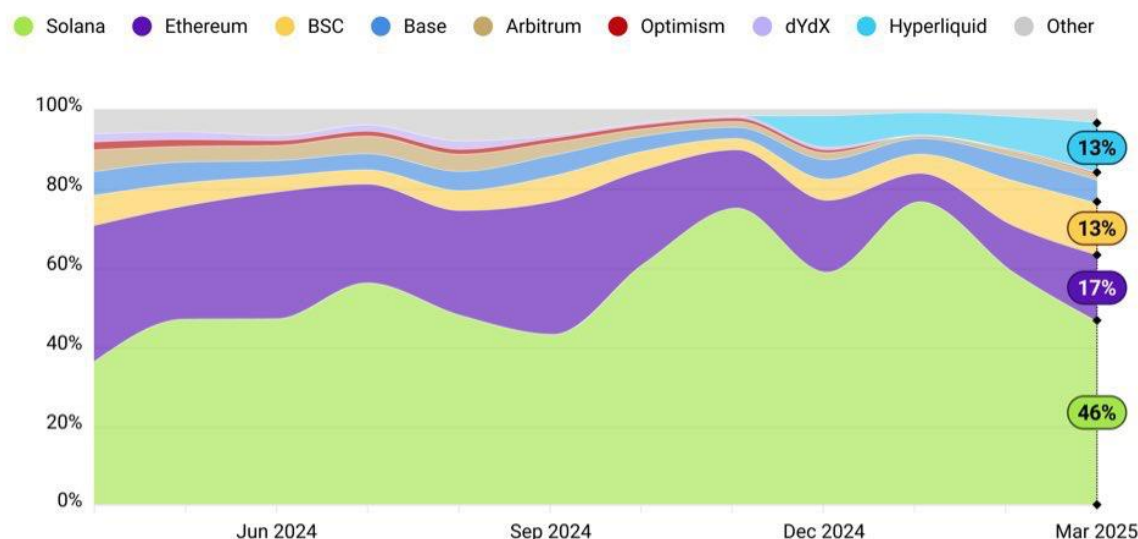


According to Blockworks analyst Gonzalez Campo, “The stablecoin supply growth means Solana’s liquidity is deeper now.” Even after the hype of meme coins such as Trump, liquidity stayed on chain, and Solana has been able to manage the growth and scale of virality.

Protocol Versus Competitors

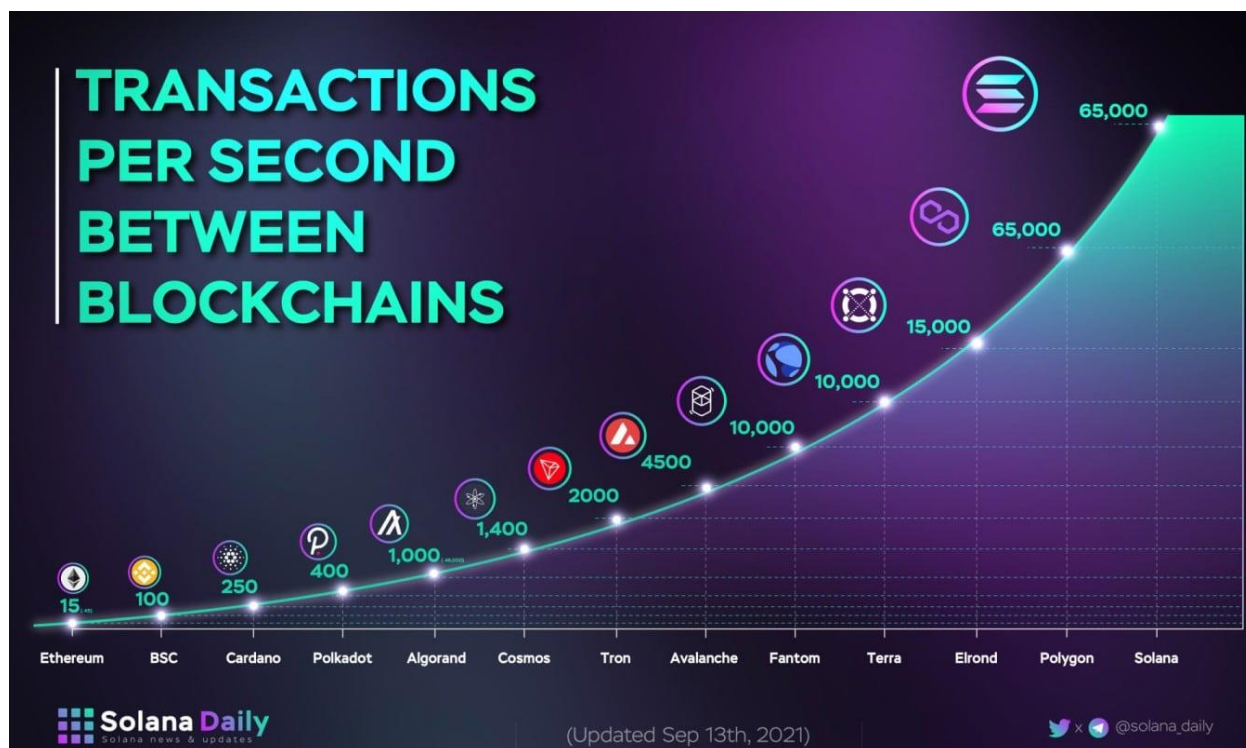
Solana's biggest comparison and competitor is arguably Ethereum. The one thing that sets apart Solana from competitors like Ethereum is its Proof of History as it is unique to Solana. When compared to Ethereum using block times and mining/validation cycles, Solana uses technology that is way faster. Compared to Ethereum transactions, Solana can make transactions way faster. Solana is also way cheaper than Ethereum. Solana is #1 in raw speed and transaction cost which is a big deal when looking at platforms like Solana. One downside found is that it is weaker in network reliability compared to Ethereum or L2s. But recently Solana’s dApps generated 46% of total revenue across all chains in March, dominating the ecosystem and maintaining strong user activity even as the memecoin frenzy cools down.

Solana DApps Revenue Share By Month



Note: Revenue figures for most chains, aside from Solana, are sourced from DefiLlama.





Protocol Go To Market Strategy Versus Competitors

Solana places an emphasis on making the blockchain accessible, notably through low transaction fees and high throughput. In doing so Solana is the top blockchain for the buying, selling, and trading of memecoins and NFTs. As digital assets become increasingly used, Solana stands an excellent low cost method of exchange that can scale with demand.

Ethereum, while being the pioneer in smart contract platforms, has faced scalability challenges. High transaction fees and slow processing times have plagued the ecosystem before as seen in 2021. Today people question Ethereum's ability to stay relevant in a world that demands high transaction speeds at low costs. Likewise, Avalanche offers a unique multi-chain architecture, enabling custom blockchains for specific applications. This can appeal to enterprises seeking specialized solutions, although the complexity can be a barrier for developers unfamiliar with its ecosystem.



Solana's strategy of providing a single, high-throughput chain simplifies development and user experience, making it an attractive platform for rapid deployment and scaling of dApps. Its growing ecosystem, coupled with strategic partnerships and continuous improvements in security and performance, underscores a commitment to becoming a leader in the blockchain space.

The Solana Foundation has been very active in building a community and supporting developers. Through grants and funding, the foundation collaborated on over 500 projects distributing more than \$100 million. Furthermore the foundation is committed to the decentralization, reliability and performance of Solana. Their work intends to further the goals of blockchain technology

How Token Extracts Value

Solana's token, SOL, has several key uses. It's burned through transaction fees, which lowers the total supply. It's also staked to help secure the network and earn rewards. SOL is used in all decentralized apps (dApps) on Solana, giving it core utility. Validators usually hold SOL, and it might be used for governance. It's also used in DeFi as collateral and for liquidity in lending, borrowing, and trading.

Tokenomics/Vesting Schedule

Solana has no maximum supply, and instead has an inflation scheme fixed to a one year rate. Solana's tokenomics follow a progressive deflationary model. The network launched with an initial inflation rate of 8%, primarily distributed through staking rewards to incentivize network participation. This rate decreases annually by 15%, tapering down until it reaches a long-term steady-state target of 1.5%. Once this 1.5% rate is reached, it is designed to continue indefinitely, supporting validator incentives while maintaining a predictable



token supply. These figures represent the maximum theoretical inflation, not accounting for token burns or lost supply, which reduce actual inflation over time.

Solana likewise employs a burn-and-reward mechanism to balance incentives and supply control. 50% of every transaction fee is permanently burned, reducing total supply, while the remaining 50% is awarded to the validator responsible for processing the transaction which encourages maximum throughput during their slot in the leader schedule. As network activity scales combined with the declining inflation schedule, strong deflationary pressure will arise over time. In the near term, net supply will still rise due to ongoing token emissions and the gradual unlocking of staked tokens, but this is expected to taper off as burn volume increases.

Modeling/Ratio Analysis

Solana's market cap of around 72.1 billion ranks it #6 against other blockchains. According to CoinGecko the circulating supply stands at about 516.8 million SOL.

Competitor	TVL	MCAP	MCAP / TVL
Solana	7.3 B	72.1 B	9.88
Ethereum	46.8 B	194.9 B	4.16
Sui	1.2 B	7.0 B	5.83
Cardano	311.5 M	22.6 B	72.55
Avalanche	1.2 B	8.3 B	6.91
Aptos	973.9 M	3.0 B	3.08



Road Map

The Solana roadmap for 2024 and the future of the platform highlights the commitment to improving scalability, security, and adoption. With ambitious upgrades like Token-22, increased interoperability, and enhanced security protocols, Solana is well-positioned for future growth. However, the platform faces several challenges, including network reliability issues and competition from other blockchains. Solana's price prediction is generally positive, with many analysts expecting significant growth as the platform continues to expand its ecosystem. While Solana price predictions vary, the potential for SOL to become a dominant player in the blockchain space is clear.

Investment Thesis

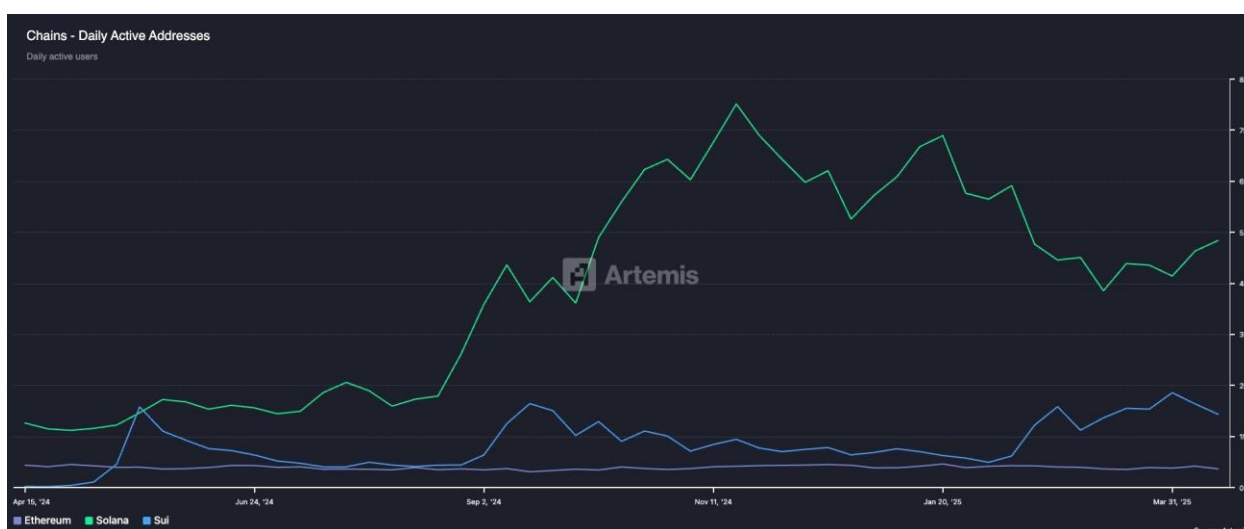
The stage that Solana is at in its development makes it an interesting investment to compliment OBG's current portfolio. It's long term performance and relative stability compared to other crypto projects puts SOL in a unique spot of being a core asset for many investors. With the macro economic climate being favorable, inflows from spot ETFs will only benefit Solana. Solana represents a unique blend of high-performance technology, rapid ecosystem growth, and improving decentralization, positioning it as one of the top long-term contenders in blockchain.

While Ethereum's market cap still dwarfs Solana's, Solana is catching up in usage. Recently on April 20, 2025 Solana overtook Ethereum in staking market cap emphasising the markets increasing interest. If Solana can continue this trend and overtake Ethereum as the main smart contract platform, long term holders of SOL could benefit immensely. The long-term addressable market for Solana is enormous: it aims to be the decentralized backbone for internet-scale applications, potentially supporting billions of users one day. Already, top institutions have collaborated with Solana such as Visa with USDC and Google Cloud. This is in addition to the ever controversial pump.fun, which supports the thousands of meme traders in addition to



platforms like Jupiter. Institutional and everyday traders all see the benefits of Solana.

Overall, Solana's ecosystem is broad and growing. Developer activity and user metrics underscore this growth. As of April 2025, daily active users on Solana hovers above 4 million, where are notable margin separates it from chains like Ethereum and Sui.



Fund Recommendation

Swap 3 \$ETH to purchase \$SOL



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Sources:

**** full URL's - on a separate page**



Source URLs

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Ethereum vs Solana: Who Will Be King in 2025?

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